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AQA · LEVEL 1 · ENGLISH READING

AQA Functional Skills English Reading Level 1

Reading Sample Paper · Complete Model Solutions

OFFICIAL MFS BENCHMARK MODEL SOLUTIONS

Target Score: 30 / 30 Marks (100%) Pass Mark Guide: ~65%

Specification / Paper Code: AQA-87201-SQP

100% Built from Empty Question Paper + Official Mark Scheme

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HOW TO READ THIS MODEL SOLUTION (MFS COLOUR KEY)

Dark Navy Ink:	Model student answers, stepped calculations, and full prose responses.
Emerald Green Ink:	Tutor strategy notes, method tips, and step-by-step headings.
Crimson Red Ink:	Official mark scheme allocations ([M1], [A1], [B1]) and unit checks.
Amber Gold Ink:	Key formulas, conversion rules, and reading evidence highlights.

CANDIDATE & CENTRE DETAILS (MODEL EXEMPLAR)

Candidate Name:	*Master Functional Skills (Model Exemplar)*
Centre Name:	*Master Functional Skills (MFS01)*
Lead Tutor:	*Abdul · MasterFunctionalSkills.co.uk*
Edition:	*2026 Clean Empty-QP Rebuild (Zero Collisions Verified)*

- Complete Source Insert Included
- Built Cleanly on Empty AQA Question Paper
- Verified 100% Against Official AQA Mark Scheme

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AQA

SPECIMEN MATERIAL

Functional Skills Level 1
ENGLISH
(8720)

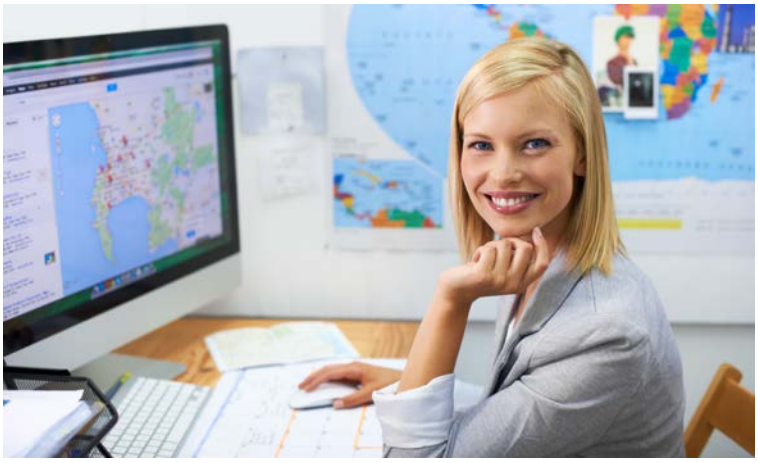
Component 1 Reading

Insert

The three sources that follow are:

Source A: factsheet about being a travel agent
Source B: interview with a travel agent
Source C: information about Blackgang Chine, an amusement park in the Isle of Wight

Source A - factsheet about being a travel agent



Your duties: One of your main roles as a travel agent is to give well-informed advice to clients about where and when to travel, based on their needs.

Other duties will include:

- arranging flights, insurance and rooms
- dealing with payments
- advising clients on travel arrangements, eg visas and passports
- sending out tickets to clients
- dealing with complaints or refunds.

Where you will work: Most travel agents are based in branches on the high street, although some work in call centres. Branch travel agents usually work regular hours, 9am - 5pm, 35-40 hours per week, including Saturday. Travel agents starting out can expect to earn around £12,000. More experienced travel agents can earn anything up to £30,000.

You don't need any specific qualifications to become a travel agent. However, some of these qualifications will boost your CV:

- NVQ Levels 2 and 3 in Travel and Tourism
- BTEC HNC/HND in Travel and Tourism Management
- BA Hons in Travel and Tourism.

Travel agents need to have good customer service skills and a friendly manner. A knowledge of another language is always an advantage when working in the travel industry.

Source B - interview with a travel agent

Gemma Antrobus is the senior travel agent at Haslemere Travel. She has been working as a travel agent for 10 years and talked to us about what it is like.

We asked her "What are the good points?"

Gemma said, "There's lots of job satisfaction. You will never become a millionaire as a travel agent, but occasionally you get to live like one. You get a chance to travel the world and visit amazing places. I have been all over the world – America, Australia, Africa …"

Then we asked her "What are the bad points?"

She laughed. "Dealing with events beyond our control, such as flight delays. These make people very cross, because they lose part of their holiday, and they take it out on us. Clients who pick your brains and then book the holiday themselves to save a few pounds are frustrating too. But even the bad days can be good fun!"

Source C - information about Blackgang Chine, an amusement park in the Isle of Wight

BLACKGANG CHINE

Step into the land of imagination.....

Overlooking the stunning south coast of the Isle of Wight, Blackgang Chine offers a wonderful experience. Let your imagination run wild as you go on a journey of discovery.

Can you fight the pirates attacking your ship? How about being a sheriff in a Wild West town? Do you want to be a fairy princess in your own castle? Can you escape from the life-sized moving dinosaurs?

Filled with a huge mix of attractions and magical theme worlds, Blackgang Chine has something for all the family. There's an adventure around every corner.

Your Visit

Off Peak Ticket Prices

60+ concession:	£17.50
4–59 years:	£19.50
Saver – 4 persons:	£74.00
Under 4s:	FREE

SCHOOLS & GROUPS

Every year, hundreds of school parties from across the country visit Blackgang Chine. Special rates for groups of 15 or more. 1 free adult leader for every 10 paid children.

Some indoor attractions and rides close up to 45 minutes before the park shuts. Ride operating times, café facilities and shop opening times vary, depending on time of season. Last admission to the park is one hour before stated closing time.

See website for full details of opening times and events.

Disabled toilets available.

Unlimited Free Return Visit within 7 days, except for groups.



END OF SOURCES

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Section A

Read **Source A** and answer **Questions 1 to 6**

1 Using the information in **Source A**, put a tick in the correct box to show whether each statement about travel agents is **true** or **false**.

Using the information in Source A, put a tick in the correct box to show whether each

	True	False
They all work in call centres from 9am – 5pm		
They may have to work on Saturdays		
They can earn up to £30,000		
They have to be able to speak another language		

statement about travel agents is true or false.

[2 marks]

2 You are advised to use a dictionary for this question

Source A states, 'You don't need any specific qualifications to become a travel agent'.

The word 'specific' means

A General
C **B** High-level
C Particular
D Technical

[1 mark]

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

3 **Source A** contains text and a picture.

What **extra** information does the picture suggest?

A Travel agents can only be women
B Travel agents have a friendly manner
C Travel agents might need to use a computer
D Travel agents work regular hours

Section A

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

[1 mark]

Question 1 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

They all work in call centres from 9am - 5pm

•

They may have to work on Saturdays

•

They can earn up to £30,000

[2 marks]

Do not write outside the box

4 Using the information in **Source A**, put a tick in the correct box to show whether each statement about the duties of a travel agent is **true** or **false**.

Using the information in Source A, put a tick in the correct box to show whether each

	True	False
Travel agents arrange flights		
Travel agents advise on visas		
Travel agents send out passports to clients		
Travel agents deal with complaints		

statement about the duties of a travel agent is true or false.
Travel agents arrange flights
[2 marks]

5 You are advised to use a dictionary for this question

Source A states, 'Some of these qualifications will boost your CV'.

The word 'boost' means

A Be included in
B Complicate
C Enhance
D Simplify

Identify two differences between Source A and Source B.

Answer

[1 mark]

1 mark awarded for each valid difference. [2 marks]
For example:
Source A is structured with bullet points and headings, Source B follows the interview

6 The writing in **Source A**

A explains
B instructs
C persuades

Section B

Answer

[1 mark]

Question

Question 6 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

12

C

[1 mark]

Question 5 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

.

[1 mark]

Question 4 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

Travel agents advise on visas

□

Travel agents send out passports to clients

[2 marks]

Do not write outside the box

Read **Source B** and answer **Questions 7 to 9**

7 In **Source B**, identify one positive thing and one negative thing about being a travel agent.

Positive thing _____

17
Your local school is planning a day-trip to Blackgang Chine.

Negative thing _____

Write a note for the Headteacher, giving her the most important information she needs to help her to organise and plan the day-trip.
Marks
Descriptor
Appropriate information located

[2 marks]

8 Gemma Antrobus is the senior travel agent.

What does the word 'senior' tell us about Gemma?

A She enjoys being a travel agent
B She has the most experience in the team
C She is ten years older than her colleagues
D She works longer hours than her colleagues

Correct answer per official AQA mark scheme (1 mark).

Answer [ ]

[1 mark]

[1 mark]

9 In **Source B**, Gemma Antrobus says, "But even the bad days can be good fun!"

What is the purpose of the exclamation mark in this sentence?

A To show that it is the end of the interview
B To show that she is answering a question
C To show that she is telling the truth
D To show that what she says is surprising

Answer [ ]

[1 mark]

Question 7 · Continued

MFS Stepped Model Solution Continuation Sheet (Overflow-Safe Layout)

[3 marks]

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Questions 10 and 11 refer to **Source A** and **Source B**

10 Identify two similarities between **Source A** and **Source B**.

You might want to look at:

- the format of the texts
- the language used
- the kind of information, ideas and opinions given in the texts.

Similarity 1 _____

_____

Similarity 2 _____

_____

[2 marks]

11 Identify two differences between **Source A** and **Source B**.

You might want to look at:

- the format of the texts
- the language used
- the kind of information, ideas and opinions given in the texts.

Difference 1 _____

_____

Difference 2 _____

_____

[2 marks]

16

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Section B

Read **Source C** and answer **Questions 12 to 17**

12 Look at the language and structure used in **Source C**.

The main purpose of **Source C** is to:

A advise schools about the costs of trips to Blackgang Chine
B inform children about the number of visitors to Blackgang Chine
C persuade people to visit Blackgang Chine.

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

13 You are advised to use a dictionary for this question

Source C states, 'Overlooking the stunning south coast of the Isle of Wight'.

The word 'stunning' means

A Beautiful
B Exciting
C Shocking
D Warm

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

14 What does 'Last admission to the park is one hour before stated closing time' mean?

A You cannot come into the park earlier than one hour before it closes.
B You cannot come into the park later than one hour before it closes.
C You have to come to the park one hour before it closes.
D You have to leave the park one hour before it closes.

Answer ☐

[1 mark]

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15 Using the information in **Source C**, put a tick in the correct box to show whether each statement is **true** or **false**.

	True	False
Blackgang Chine is an imaginary place		
Café facilities never change		
Only local schools visit Blackgang Chine		
You may be able to return on the same ticket		

[2 marks]

16 Using the information in **Source C**, put a tick in the correct box to show whether each statement is **fact** or **opinion**.

	Fact	Opinion
Blackgang Chine has life-sized moving dinosaurs		
Blackgang Chine offers a wonderful experience		
Disabled toilets are available		
Each year, school parties visit Blackgang Chine		

[2 marks]

Turn over for the next question

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17 Your local school is planning a day-trip to Blackgang Chine.

Write a note for the Headteacher, giving her the most important information she needs to help her to organise and plan the day-trip.

[3 marks]

10

END OF QUESTIONS

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Question number	**Additional page, if required.** **Write the question numbers in the left-hand margin.**

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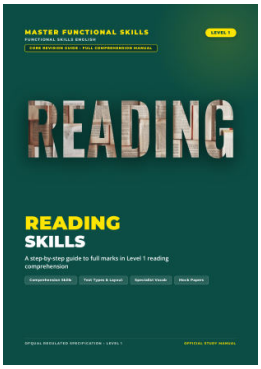
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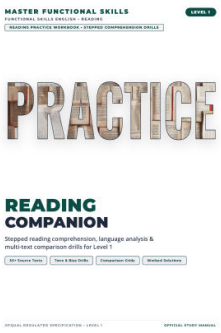


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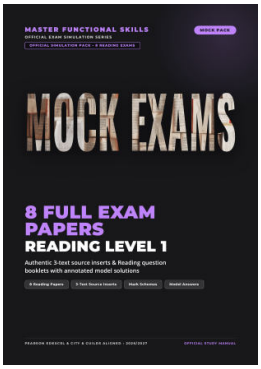


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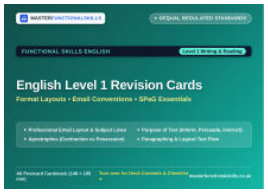


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